

J-TACS

PARTNER

The Partner's Handbook

Everything J-TACS does, from the first login to the day your practice runs on it. Read it once end to end — after that it is a reference.

Setting up your firm

Roles & permissions

Client onboarding

Leads & quotations

Work allocation

Billing & approvals

Team oversight

Statutory registers

What's in here

1	The shape of the app	How J-TACS is laid out and why
2	Day one: your firm exists	Sign up, first login, what to do in the first hour
3	Setting up the firm	Identity, branding, approval limits, email, schedules
4	Who sees what	The four roles and the exact line between them
5	Building your team	Adding people, issuing logins, leavers
6	Bringing clients in	The onboarding wizard and the Client 360 screen
7	Leads, quotations, clients	The pipeline from enquiry to engagement
8	Getting work done	Tasks, filings, reviews and templates
9	Money	Invoices, approvals, payments and what you can see
10	Watching the firm	Performance, attendance, reports, audit trail
11	Registers and safekeeping	Credentials, DSC, UDIN, the recycle bin
★	Quick reference	One page to keep next to your desk

1 The shape of the app

Before any buttons: J-TACS is one workspace for your firm. Everything in it belongs to your firm and nobody outside it can see a single row. Inside, what a person sees depends on their role.

One firm, one workspace

Signing up creates your firm. Every client, task, invoice and document is stamped with it. Another firm using J-TACS cannot see your data even if you both act for the same company.

Four kinds of people

Partner runs the firm. **Manager** runs the work. **Employee** does the work. **Client** gets a read-only portal. You are the Partner.

The sidebar is role-aware

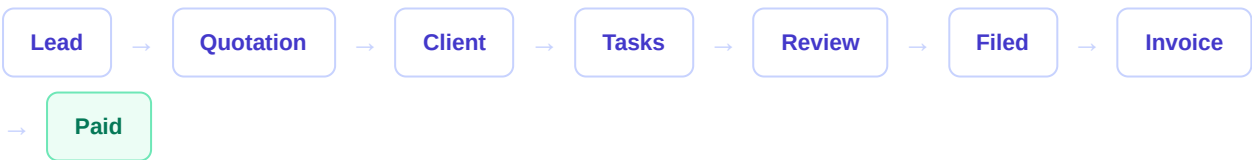
You see roughly twenty-five destinations. A Manager sees fewer, an Employee about a dozen. Nobody is shown a door they cannot open.

Clients are the spine

Almost everything hangs off a client — tasks, filings, invoices, documents, workpapers. The **Client 360** screen gathers all of it in one place.

How work flows through the firm

Read left to right. This is the whole product in one line, and the rest of this manual simply expands each box.



Your sidebar

Grouped, collapsible, and yours to rearrange. Hover any item and click the star to pin it to **Favourites** at the top. The three places you have been most recently appear under **Recent**.

J-TACS

QUICK ACTIONS

New Client
New Task
New Invoice
New Quote

OPERATIONS

Dashboard

Clients
Work Tracker
Filings
GST Recon
ITR Computation
Notices
Financial Statements
Calendar
Timesheet
Client Groups

SALES / CRM

Leads & Quotations

FINANCE

Payments
Invoices

PEOPLE

Employees
Performance

COMMUNICATION

Messaging

MANAGEMENT

Reports
Revenue
Fee Realisation
Audit Logs
Job Templates
Registers
Notifications
Recycle Bin
Settings

Only the Partner sees all seven groups. Audit Logs is Partner-only.

Collapse the sidebar

Click the rail on its edge to shrink it to icons and win back screen width. Your favourites and groups stay exactly as you left them.

2 Day one: your firm exists

Signing up creates the firm and makes you its founding Partner. There is a fourteen-day trial and no card is asked for. Here is the first hour.

1

Sign up

Go to the sign-up page and enter your name, your firm's name, your email and a password. That single act creates the workspace and makes you the founding Partner. There is no separate 'create firm' step afterwards.

2

Confirm your email and sign in

Use the same email address at [Sign in](#). If you ever forget the password, [Forgot password](#) on the login screen sends a reset link — you never need anyone's help for this.

3

Land on an empty dashboard

It will be empty, and that is correct. Every count is zero because you have no clients yet. Nothing is broken.

4

Fill in the firm's details

Go to [Settings](#) and complete your firm identity before anything else. Invoices, engagement letters and client emails all draw on it, so doing it now saves reissuing documents later. Chapter 3 walks through every field.

5

Add your first person, or your first client

Either order works. Most firms add two or three team members first so that work can be assigned the moment clients arrive.

You are the only Partner until you say otherwise

Nobody else can grant the Partner or Manager role. When you add team members they become Employees unless you deliberately choose otherwise — and only you can make somebody a Manager.

What to expect on the dashboard

Once the firm has data, the dashboard is your standing view of it: work due, work overdue, who is online, money outstanding and the month's numbers. Until then it shows empty states that tell you what would appear there.

3 Setting up the firm

Ten minutes here decides how the product behaves for everybody else. Open [Settings](#) from the sidebar.

Firm identity

Your firm's name, address, PAN, GSTIN and ICAI firm registration number. These print on invoices, quotations and engagement letters. Get the FRN right — it appears on documents that go to clients and to authorities.

Branding

Upload your logo. It appears on the invoices and quotations your clients receive, and in the client portal. A logo is the difference between a document that looks like it came from your firm and one that looks like it came from software.

Bank details

Account name, number, IFSC and UPI. These print on every invoice so clients know where to pay. An invoice without them generates a phone call.

The invoice approval limit

This is the most consequential setting on the page, and the one most often left blank. Set an amount, and any invoice a **Manager** raises above it is held for your approval before it can go out.

WHO RAISES IT	AMOUNT	WHAT HAPPENS
Partner	Any	Goes out immediately. You are never gated.
Manager	At or under the limit	Goes out immediately.
Manager	Over the limit	Held, marked <i>awaiting approval</i> , and waits for a Partner.
Anyone	Limit left blank	Nothing is ever held. Every invoice goes straight out.

A blank limit means no approvals at all

If you leave the field empty, Managers can raise an invoice of any size without you seeing it first. That may be exactly what you want in a small firm — just decide it deliberately rather than by default.

Email

J-TACS sends staff invitations, client reminders and portal invites by email. Until email is configured, none of those arrive and the failure is quiet. Your administrator sets this up once during installation; the `/docs/email-setup` page inside the app has the steps. Send yourself a test before you rely on it.

Scheduled jobs

Several things happen without anyone clicking: deadline reminders go out, retainer invoices are raised, overdue invoices are flagged, attendance is closed off at the end of the day, and stale work is escalated. These run on a schedule configured at installation.

Worth confirming once

Ask whoever installed J-TACS to confirm the scheduled jobs are running. If they are not, everything still works when a person clicks it — but nothing happens on its own, and the silence looks identical to 'nothing was due'.

4 Who sees what

Choosing somebody's role is the highest-consequence decision in the app: it decides whether they can see every client's fees. Here is the exact line.

ROLE	IN ONE LINE	WHAT IT GRANTS	WHERE IT STOPS
Partner	Runs the firm.	Firm settings and branding · approving and waiving invoices · adding and removing Managers · deleting clients and staff · the audit trail	Nothing. You see everything.
Manager	Runs the work.	Every client, task, invoice and quotation in the firm · adding Employees and assigning their work · raising invoices and recording payments	Cannot change firm settings · cannot create another Manager or remove a Partner · invoices over the limit still need you
Employee	Does the work.	Their own tasks, deadlines and timesheet · only the clients they are assigned to	Cannot see anyone else's clients · no access to invoices, payments or fees at all · cannot sign off their own filings
Client	Your customer.	A read-only portal: their documents, their filing status, their invoices	Sees only their own record, and only what you publish to them

The same thing, screen by screen

SCREEN	PARTNER	MANAGER	EMPLOYEE
Dashboard, Clients, Work Tracker, Calendar, Timesheet, Messaging	Yes	Yes	Yes
GST Recon, ITR Computation, Notices, Financial Statements	Yes	Yes	Yes — own clients
Filings (compliance overview)	Yes	Yes	No
Invoices	Yes	Yes	No
Payments dashboard	Yes	No	No
Leads & Quotations	Yes	Yes	No
Employees, Reports, Job Templates, Registers, Client Groups, Recycle Bin	Yes	Yes	No

SCREEN	PARTNER	MANAGER	EMPLOYEE
Performance / Workforce	Yes	Yes	No
Audit Logs	Yes	No	No

Employees and money

An Employee cannot reach invoices, payments or fees anywhere in the product — not through a screen, not through a search result, not on the client's own page. The billing tabs are not merely hidden from them; the data is never sent. You can assign work freely without exposing what you charge for it.

Deciding between Manager and Employee

Ask one question: *should this person see every client's fees?* If yes, Manager. If no, Employee. Everything else follows from that.

5 Building your team

Adding someone happens in two stages: you create their record, then you issue them a login. Keeping those separate lets you set up an entire team before anybody can sign in.

1 Open Employees and add the person

Go to **Employees** → **Add Employee**. Name, email, designation, department, joining date. **The email matters** — a login cannot be issued without one, and it is where their invitation goes.

2 Choose their role

The role picker explains what each role grants and where it stops, right in the dialog. Only you can choose **Manager**; a Manager adding staff can only create Employees.

3 Issue the login

On the employee's row, choose **Issue login**. J-TACS creates the account, generates a temporary password and emails it to them. The screen also shows you the password once, in case the email does not arrive.

4 They sign in and change it

They use their email and the temporary password, then set their own. From that moment they see the app through their role.

5 Assign them clients and work

An Employee sees nothing until they are assigned to a client or given a task. A brand-new Employee with an empty screen is not a fault — they have not been given anything yet.

One login per person

If someone already has a login, **Issue login** will refuse and tell you to use **Reset password** instead. That is deliberate: two accounts for one person split their work history in half.

Importing a team in one go

If you are moving from spreadsheets, **Import** on the Employees page takes a CSV. The dialog shows the exact column format with a worked example. Import first, issue logins afterwards.

When somebody leaves

There are two different actions and they are not interchangeable.

ACTION	WHAT IT DOES	USE IT WHEN
Disable	Their login stops working immediately. Their record, history and completed work all stay. They can be re-enabled.	Somebody has left, is on long leave, or you need to cut access today.
Delete	Removes the person from the active roster. Partner only.	A record created in error, or a genuine cleanup.

Open work is checked before either

If the person still has open tasks, J-TACS stops and tells you how many, rather than quietly stranding the work where nobody will look for it. Reassign first — the [Reassign work](#) action moves everything to another team member in one step — then disable or delete.

6 Bringing clients in

Client onboarding is a five-step wizard rather than a form. Each step builds something the firm uses later, so finishing it properly means the work, the checklist and the deadlines already exist on day one.

The five steps

1

Basic Information

Name, client code, type of entity, PAN, GSTIN, contact details. PAN and GSTIN are checked as you type — a GSTIN with a bad checksum is caught here rather than at filing time. If the PAN or GSTIN already belongs to another client, you are sent back to this step and offered the existing record instead of creating a duplicate.

2

Services Selection

Tick what you will do for them: GST, income tax, TDS, audit, ROC, accounting, and so on. This decides everything downstream.

3

Service Configuration

For each service, the specifics — GST filing frequency (monthly or QRMP), whether they are audit-liable, the fee basis. This is what makes deadlines correct for *this* client rather than generic.

4

Document Checklist

What you need from them. It becomes the checklist your team works against and the list the client sees in their portal.

5

Compliance Setup

The recurring deadlines and reminders. Finish this and the client's statutory calendar is already populated — nobody has to remember to set up GSTR-3B every month.

The wizard will not let you skip ahead

A later step stays locked until the ones before it are valid. It is not being awkward: a document checklist with no services chosen has nothing to list.

Client status, and what it means

Active

Pending

On hold

Inactive

These are not decoration. **Active** clients appear in work allocation and billing runs. **On hold** and **Inactive** clients are held out of automatic billing and reminders — which is the point of setting them.

The Client 360 screen

Click any client and you get everything about them under one set of tabs. This is where you and your Managers will spend most of your time.

TAB	WHAT LIVES THERE
Overview	The summary, key dates, and portal access for the client
Services	What you do for them and on what terms
Tasks	Every piece of work, open and closed
Payments	Invoices, receipts and outstanding balance — <i>Partner and Manager only</i>
Documents	Everything filed against them, plus document requests
Compliance	Their filing calendar and status by period
Workpapers	GST reconciliation, ITR computation, financial statements, notices
Engagement	Engagement letter, terms and fee — <i>Partner and Manager only</i>
Activity	Who did what on this client
Timeline	The client's history as a single narrative

Bulk import and groups

Import on the Clients page takes a CSV for moving an existing book across. **Client Groups** ties related entities together — a family, or a group of companies — so you can see and bill them as one.

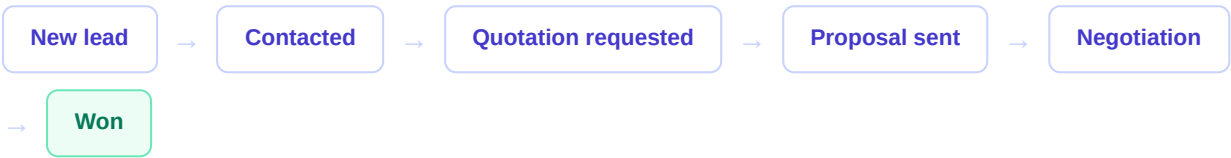
Clients with no email

A client with no email address cannot be sent reminders, invoices or a portal invitation, and the app will tell you so rather than silently skipping them. If a client genuinely has no email, that is fine — just know their reminders will need a phone call.

7 Leads, quotations, clients

Every client starts as somebody who called. **Leads & Quotations** is where that conversation lives until it becomes an engagement — or does not.

The lead pipeline



Two more stages sit alongside these for the situations that actually happen: **Follow-up required** and **Client will revert**. A lead that goes nowhere is marked **Lost** — which keeps it in your conversion numbers instead of vanishing.

Quotations

Build a quotation from a lead, line by line. It gets a public link you can send; you can see when the client has viewed it, and they can accept or reject it without needing a login.



STATUS	MEANING
Draft	Being written. Not visible to anyone outside the firm.
Pending approval	Waiting on a Partner, if your firm requires it.
Approved	Cleared internally, ready to send.
Sent	The client has the link.
Viewed	They have opened it. Useful before you chase.
Accepted	They said yes. Convert the lead to a client.
Rejected	They said no — with their reason recorded.
Expired	Its validity date passed without an answer.
Superseded	Replaced by a revision. Kept for the audit trail; the old link no longer answers.

An approved quotation cannot be quietly edited

Once a quotation has been approved or sent, changing the numbers creates a **revision** and marks the old one *superseded*. Both are kept. This is what stops a figure the client agreed to from being altered afterwards with no record.

Turning a won lead into a client

Accepting a quotation converts the lead into a client and carries the agreed services and fees across, so you are not retyping the deal you just closed. You land in the onboarding wizard from Chapter 6 with the commercial terms already filled in.

Knowing what your pipeline is worth

Fee Realisation under Management compares what you quoted, what you actually invoiced and what you collected — by client and by service. It is the report that shows where quoted work quietly failed to turn into money.

8 Getting work done

Work Tracker is the firm's task list. Every piece of work belongs to a client, has an owner and a due date, and moves through a small set of statuses everybody understands.

The six statuses



STATUS	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS
Not started	Assigned, not yet begun.
In progress	Someone is working on it now.
Data awaited	Blocked on the client. This is the one that tells you to pick up the phone.
Under review	Finished by the doer, waiting for a reviewer. Employees end here.
Filed / Done	Signed off. Only a Manager or Partner can set this.
On hold	Deliberately paused.

Nobody signs off their own filing

An Employee cannot mark work **Filed / Done**. They submit it as **Under review** and a Manager or Partner signs it off. This is separation of duties, enforced by the app rather than by memory.

Assigning work

When you assign a task, J-TACS checks the assignment before it saves and tells you what it found.

WHAT IT FINDS	WHAT HAPPENS
The person's account is disabled	Blocked. The work would simply be lost.
They are the named reviewer for this task	Blocked. They cannot review their own work.
They are on leave when it falls due	Warning. Assigning ahead to cover leave is normal, so it does not stop you.
They already have more than they can do	Warning, with the arithmetic shown — tasks per working day.

Accepting and declining

An assigned task waits for the person to accept it. If they cannot take it, they decline **with a reason** — no capacity, not my client, outside what I do, not enough information, away when it is due, or something else — and it comes back to you rather than sitting on their list untouched.

Job templates

Job Templates under Management turns a recurring engagement into a reusable checklist. Define your GST monthly filing or a statutory audit once, with its steps and typical durations, and apply it to any client instead of rebuilding it each time.

Filings and the calendar

Filings shows filing status by client and period — the grid you use to answer "is everyone's GSTR-3B done".

Calendar puts statutory dates and your firm's own dates in one place, because nobody plans a month across two calendars.

Work can move backwards

Corrected figures arrive and work genuinely goes back a stage. J-TACS allows it — sending something back from review, or reopening filed work, just requires a reason. A practice is not a one-way conveyor belt, and an app that pretends otherwise gets worked around.

9 Money

Invoices, receipts and the reports that tell you whether the work you did turned into money. Employees see none of this.

Raising an invoice

1

Start it

[New Invoice](#) from the sidebar, or the Payments tab on a client. Pick the client and the services.

2

Check the client's GST details

If the client's GSTIN is missing, you are told before the invoice is raised rather than after it has gone out. A tax invoice without a GSTIN is a reissue waiting to happen.

3

Bill the time, if you track it

Unbilled time entries for that client can be pulled onto the invoice. Time recorded against a rate becomes money here; time recorded without one is just a number.

4

Send it

It goes out as a branded PDF with your logo and bank details. There is a print view for everything a client might reasonably want on paper.

Invoice statuses

Draft

Sent

Partially paid

Paid

Overdue

Disputed

Waived

Paid is earned, not typed

Paid and **Partially paid** cannot be set by hand. They are derived from the payments you actually record, so the status and the receipts can never disagree. Use [Record Payment](#).

A **Draft** invoice is never treated as overdue — it has not been sent to anybody. Only invoices that have genuinely been issued and still have a balance are chased.

Approvals — your gate

If you set an approval limit in Chapter 3, invoices raised by a Manager above it appear in your approvals queue. Nothing goes to the client until you clear it. You can also **waive** an invoice, which is recorded as a deliberate decision rather than a deletion.

Credit notes

Issue a credit note against an invoice when you need to reduce it. J-TACS knows the section 34 deadline — a credit note affecting GST liability must be issued by 30 November following the financial year of supply — and will tell you when you are past it.

The three money reports

Payments

Partner-only. The overall position: what is outstanding, what is ageing, who owes you.

Revenue

Invoice-level ledger with an Excel export. The one to hand your accountant.

Fee Realisation

Quoted vs invoiced vs collected, by client and by service. Where the leakage is.

Reports

Everything else — workload, compliance status, client profitability — with exports.

10 Watching the firm

Four screens answer the questions a Partner actually asks: who is working, how much, on what, and who changed that.

Performance

Performance under People shows the team: who is online now, hours worked, tasks completed, utilisation and capacity. Click into any individual for their own view.

How hours are counted

Worth understanding, because people will ask you.

The app counts presence, not the clock

While someone is working with J-TACS open, their browser quietly reports in every few minutes. Minutes accrue from those check-ins. **It only counts while the tab is actually visible** — so a laptop left open overnight does not bill the night as work, and nobody has to remember to clock out. If a session goes quiet it is closed off automatically at the last point the person was genuinely there.

Someone reads as **online** while they are active, drops to **idle** after twenty minutes of nothing, and their session is closed off after forty-five. Attendance can also be marked **present**, **absent**, **late**, **half day** or **on leave**, and exported.

Timesheets

Timesheet is where hours are recorded against clients and tasks. Time marked billable and carrying a rate can be pulled onto an invoice. Time with no rate is measurement, not money — if you intend to bill by the hour, make sure rates are set.

Reports

Workload by person, compliance status across the book, client profitability, revenue and realisation. Most export to Excel.

Audit logs

Audit Logs is **Partner only**. Every consequential action — who changed a fee, who deleted a client, who approved an invoice, who signed off a filing — with who and when. Neither Managers nor Employees can see it, which is what makes it worth having.

The one screen to check weekly

Performance, on a Monday. Overdue work and people at capacity show up there before they show up as an angry client.

11 Registers and safekeeping

The statutory records a practice must keep, and the safety net for when something is deleted by mistake.

Registers

Credentials vault

Government portal logins — GST, income tax, MCA, TRACES — encrypted at rest. This is what stops portal passwords living in a shared spreadsheet.

DSC register

Digital signature certificates: whose, which authority, expiry. An expired DSC discovered on a filing deadline is a bad day.

UDIN register

UDINs generated, against which client and which engagement — linked to the work rather than kept in a separate list.

Statutory registrations

Each client's registrations and their renewal dates.

Guard the vault key

The credentials vault is encrypted with a key held in your installation's configuration. If that key is ever changed or lost, **every stored credential becomes permanently unreadable**. Make sure whoever administers your installation has it backed up somewhere safe.

The recycle bin

Deleting a client, invoice or task does not destroy it — it goes to [Recycle Bin](#), where a Partner or Manager can restore it. Records are retained in line with SQC 1's seven-year expectation, so deleting something is a reversible mistake rather than a permanent one.

Documents

Documents are stored per client with versions and an activity trail. [Document Requests](#) lets you ask a client for a specific list and see what has arrived — the checklist you built during onboarding becomes the request you send.

Getting help inside the app

The help centre in the app covers the common questions and links to setup guides. It is quicker than this manual for a single question.

Partner quick reference

The things you will look up more than once.

First hour

- Sign up → you are the founding Partner
- **Settings** → firm identity, logo, bank details
- **Settings** → set the invoice approval limit
- Confirm email sending works — test it
- Add two or three team members
- Onboard your first client

Only a Partner can

- Change firm settings and branding
- Create a Manager
- Approve or waive an invoice over the limit
- Delete a client or a team member
- See the audit log
- Open the Payments dashboard

Task statuses

Not started	assigned, not begun
In progress	being worked on
Data awaited	blocked on the client
Under review	waiting for sign-off
Filed / Done	Manager or Partner only
On hold	deliberately paused

Lead pipeline

New lead	just arrived
Contacted	spoken to
Quotation requested	they want a price
Proposal sent	quote is with them
Negotiation	discussing terms
Won / Lost	closed either way

Adding a person

1. Employees → Add Employee
2. Enter a real email — required for login
3. Choose the role (only you can pick Manager)
4. Issue login → temp password is emailed
5. Assign them clients or tasks

Before removing a person

- Check their open tasks
- Use **Reassign work** to move it all at once
- Then **Disable** (reversible) or **Delete**
- Disable keeps history; use it for leavers

Money rules

- **Paid** comes from recorded receipts, never typed
- A **Draft** invoice is never chased as overdue
- Blank approval limit = no approvals at all
- Credit notes: 30 Nov after the FY of supply
- Employees see no fees, anywhere

If something looks wrong

- **No emails arriving** — email config; test from Settings
- **No reminders at all** — scheduled jobs may not be running
- **Employee sees nothing** — they have no clients assigned
- **Deleted by mistake** — Recycle Bin
- **Who changed this?** — Audit Logs